

Find out more

Each main entry falls into one of five key subject areas, indicated by the symbol in the top left-hand corner of the page. The picture cross-references at the bottom of the page offer suggestions for related entries to look up.

Life in the Past

Learn all about ancient civilizations and prehistoric life in this key subject area.

World of Nature

This subject area covers the natural world, from birds to polar lands.

Continents of the World
Information about regions, countries, and continents is found in this key subject area.

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Polar lands

The polar lands lie around the north and south poles. The frozen ground and icy climate make them a hard place for plants to grow.

Ice field
A lot of the land in the polar regions is covered by huge sheets of ice, called ice fields.

Glaciers flow from the ice fields. Glaciers are rivers of ice that move slowly down mountain slopes.

Antarctica
No one lives in the Antarctic, but scientists visit to study the land and its wildlife.

Polar plants
Mosses grow in thick cushions. This protects them from icy winds.

The Arctic wormwood stores food in its roots to help it survive.

Grasses grow quickly in the spring when there are long periods of daylight.

Primroses have long roots to help them survive.

Life in the Arctic
People have lived in the Arctic for thousands of years. They have had to adapt their lifestyle to the harsh climate.

Water cow
Dog-pulled sleds make it possible to move goods across the ice.

Worm clothes are made from animal skins.

Sled
Husky

Fleabane grows only for a few weeks in the Arctic summer.

Tundra
The tundra is the frozen ground.

Did you know?
• Antarctica is bigger than Europe and the US put together.
• Antarctica is actually a desert! It gets no rain all year round.

Scientists
Scientists from around the world visit Antarctica to study the land and its wildlife.

Tourism
Tourists admire Antarctica's scenery from large cruise ships.

Wildlife
Some animals and a few simple plants have adapted to life here. The animals hunt for food in the ocean.

Albatross, Penguins, Moss, Seal and seal

Find out more → Explorers 61 → Polar lands 112

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Antarctica

Antarctica is a vast, ice-covered continent near the south pole. No one lives here permanently. It is the coldest and windiest place on Earth.

Antarctic summer
In some places, the ice melts in summer. But the ground remains frozen.

Icebergs
Icebergs are huge chunks of ice that break off from the land and float in the ocean.

South pole
The south pole is the most southerly point on the Earth.

Explorers at south pole

Minerals
Beneath the ice and rock lie coal, copper, gold, and other valuable materials.

Tourism
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Wildlife
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The picture cross-references guide you to other main entries.

Life Today

If you look up topics in this key subject area, you will find out about everything from transportation to sports.

Science and Technology

This key subject area includes everything in the world of science, from the human body to space travel.

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Explorers

For thousands of years people have explored the world, hoping to find fertile farmland, fine goods, and riches.

Travelers
Pacific islanders were the first to cross the Pacific Ocean.

The Vikings sailed to the south to find fertile farmland.

Merchants explored the route between China and Europe to trade in silk.

Arabs traveled in the 13th century to trade and find new lands.

Columbus, Spanish explorer, crossed the Atlantic Ocean using an astrolabe.

Sailing ship
Starting in the 1400s, European sailors explored the world in fast, sturdy ships like this one.

Four masts for large sails

Sailors spotted land from the crow's nest

Ship's compass

Room for cargo, food, and water

Finding the way
Explorers used the sun, stars, and instruments to find their way.

Sextant

Backstaff

Telescope

Goods brought home
Explorers brought home new foods and riches from around the world.

Jade

Clives

Cinnamon

Pineapple

Did you know?
Before the 1320's, most people thought the world was flat!

Find out more → Vikings 145 → Ships and boats 127

ABCDEF GHIJK LMNOP QRSTUVW XYZ

Ships and boats

Ships and boats carry passengers and goods up and down rivers, over lakes, and from port to port across oceans and seas.

Anchor
Anchors act as brakes. They dig into the seabed and stop ships from moving.

Cruise ship
All boats do a particular kind of job. A cruise ship gives passengers a vacation at sea.

Swimming pool

Rope
Ropes are used a lot on boats. Knots hold things in place.

Lifeboat
The bridge is where the captain controls the ship from.

Anchor

Did you know?
Cargo ships carry up to 2,700 containers. These would stack almost twice as high as Mount Everest!

Flares
Flares are like fireworks. They lead rescuers to where you are.

Life jackets
Life jackets help people float if they fall into the water.

Life rafts
Life rafts are used to carry passengers if their boat sinks.

Rudder for steering

Safety
All ships carry rescue equipment in case of accidents at sea.

Hull

Moving in water
Different boats move in different ways.

Motorboats have an engine that turns a propeller.

Rowboats
Rowboats have oars to move them through the water.

Sailboats
Sailboats are driven by the wind.

Trawlers
Trawlers are fishing boats. They drag a net that scoops up fish from the sea.

Frigates
Frigates have masts on board to strike enemy ships in times of war.

Paddle steamers
Paddle steamers go up and down rivers. They are driven by a wheel at the back.

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Transportation

People use all kinds of vehicles to travel long or short distances, and to carry heavy loads from place to place.

Transportation of the world
Planes are a fast way to carry people and goods around the world.

Tuk-tuks
Tuk-tuks are small trucks used as taxis in Thailand.

Bicycles
Bicycles are cheap and clean. They are popular in China.

Paddle steamers
Paddle steamers carry people up and down rivers.

Traditional Indian cart with mule

A car of the future

Animals as transportation
Elephants in Asia carry very heavy loads. The driver is called a mahout.

Streetscars are electric buses, running on rails in some city centers.

Camels
Camels are often called ships of the desert. They can carry goods and people in the heat.

Donkeys
Donkeys are very strong. They can carry people up steep mountain paths.

Did you know?
A boat takes 3 1/2 days to cross the Atlantic Ocean, while a plane takes 3 1/2 hours.

A modern bullet train from Japan

Find out more → Aircraft 10 → Bicycles 29